# MEHMET BAHA DURSUN

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am a robotics engineer who is deliberately moving from classical autonomy into robot learning and manipulation, and I would like to make that move with a team that is already doing this work well. Most of what I have built is documented on my portfolio at renbago.github.io/MehmetBahaDursun, where each project has its own page with code, videos, and an honest account of what worked and what did not.

My background is production robotics. At Saha Robotik I built much of the core localization and mapping architecture, along with the dynamic and static obstacle-detection algorithm, for a fleet of more than 400 service robots running 24/7. I led the Istanbul Airport guide-robot project end to end, from a 187,514 m2 map and the localization setup through field testing and commissioning the first robot into daily operation. That work taught me what it takes for a robot to survive contact with the real world rather than a demo.

Over the past year I have been retraining myself toward learning-based robotics. As a student research assistant at the University of Southern Denmark, I built the full diffusion-policy pipeline for a bimanual suturing task on the physical da Vinci Research Kit: data collection, dataset conversion, training, ROS deployment, and closed-loop evaluation on the real robot. When the policy failed, I did not just collect more data. I built representation probes, adapting decoder feature inversion from LeWorldModel, found that the vision encoder was discarding the needle, and fixed the behavior by moving to a fine-tuned DINOv2 encoder with state dropout. In parallel I am leading a new bimanual mobile-manipulation project at Saha, built on OpenArm, LeRobot, and vision-language-action policies, toward a planned Eurostars collaboration between SDU and Saha.

What I am looking for now is the part I cannot give myself: senior people to learn from. I have been the person others came to for answers for a while, and in this new field I would rather be the one asking. I learn quickly, I am comfortable being corrected, and I am used to owning a problem from hardware bring-up through deployment. I am also aware of what I do not know yet, which is exactly why I want to sit next to people who have shipped learned manipulation at a level I have not reached.

On availability, I am currently doing my MSc in Advanced Robotics at SDU, so I am looking for an internship or a part-time position that fits alongside my studies and thesis. I would be glad for that to grow into a full-time role once I graduate, and I would happily shape my thesis around work that is useful to your team.

Thank you for reading. I would welcome the chance to talk about where I could be useful and what I would need to learn to get there.

Sincerely,

**Mehmet Baha Dursun**